Children acquire important life skills and values by observing and imitating grown- ups like parents or teachers. Can it be the other way round? Now, you are going to listen to the poem 'Once Upon a Time', where a parent wants to learn something from the son. Let's find out how.

Once upon a time, son
They used to laugh with their hearts
And laugh with their eyes:
But now they only **laugh with their teeth**
While their **ice-block-cold eyes**
**Search behind my shadow**.

There was a time indeed
They used to shake hands with their hearts
But that's gone, son
Now they shake hands without hearts
**While their left hands search**
**My empty pockets**.



"Feel at home!", "Come again":
They say, and when I come
Again and feel
At home, once, twice
There will be no thrice -
For then I find doors shut on me.

So I have learnt many things, son
I have learned to wear many faces
Like dresses – home face
Office face, street face, host face
**Cocktail face**, with all their **conforming smiles**
**Like a fixed portrait smile**.




And I have learned too
To laugh with only my teeth
And shake hands without my heart
I have also learned to say "Goodbye"
When I mean "**Good-riddance**":
To say "Glad to meet you"
Without being glad; and to say "It's been
Nice talking to you", after being bored.



01-B-Poem-Once upon a time.indd 21 11-01-2019 15:36:40